INDIVIDUAL IN-DEPTH INTERVIEW GUIDE

Demand for Modern Contraception in sub-Saharan Africa: New Methods, New Evidence

Part A.1: Background Information

I'd like to start by asking you some questions about yourself.

S/N	Question	Response
1	How long have you lived in [name of village/town/city]?	
2	Where were you born?	
3	What is your age? *[Probe]* ***If cannot answer, ask for year of birth.** ***If still cannot answer:** then ask about relevant historical events that happened at the time of their birth, who was the [president/country/state/district leader/LGA chairman]; if there is an age mate or age group system you can ask about that to determine age group. ***(Record all responses in space provided)***	
4	Please tell me about the size and composition of the family you grew up in. *[Follow up questions, if necessary]* **How many brothers and sisters did you have while growing up?* **How many survived beyond their 18th birthday?*	
5	What is your religion? *[Follow up question]* ***Only if relevant to respondent's religion:*** **What is your denomination?*	
6	What is your tribe? *[Follow up questions]* **What is your mother's tribe?* **What is your father's tribe?*	
7	Did you attend formal schooling? *[Follow up questions]* **If answer is yes, then ask: What is the highest level of education you completed?*	
8	What is the main kind of work that you do? *[Follow up question]* **What else do you do to earn money?*	

Demand for Modern Contraception in sub-Saharan Africa: New Methods, New Evidence
In-Depth Interview Guide for Individual Interviews

Instructions: The interview will begin with a verbal informed consent process involving acknowledgement that the respondent agrees that the study has been explained to them and that all their questions have been satisfactorily answered, that they have given their consent to be interviewed, and to have the interview audio recorded.

Check: Please ensure you have completed Part A.1: Background Information before proceeding.

Ask: May I turn on the audio recorder?

After turning on the recorder, say, "Today is ..[date]…, and I am …[name]…This interview is …[say ID]…

Just to confirm, do you give your consent to participate in this interview?

Part A.2: Additional Background Information

Thank you so much for sharing the earlier information you provided with me. I'd like to continue by asking you some more questions about yourself.

9. What is your marital status?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
** Are you currently married or living together with your partner as if you are married?*
** Is your marriage monogamous or polygamous?*
** If in polygynous union, which position are you?*
**Is this your first marriage or have you been married before?*
**Does your partner have a spouse or any other partners?*

10. How long have you been in your current relationship?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
** When did you get married?*
**When did you start living together with your partner?*

11. How old were you when you got married [or started living together with your partner]?

12. How many children have you ever [had/given birth to]? How many do you currently have?

[Note down participant's responses for later]

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

***[For women]:** Are you currently pregnant?*

**How many are boys?*

**How many are girls?*

**How old is the youngest?*

Skip if participant has 0 children: 12. How old were you when you had your first child?

Part B.1: Value of children and family size influences

Now I'd like to get your opinion about having children – the benefits, the burdens.

1. In your opinion, what are the greatest benefits of having children?

   [Follow up question, if not already answered]

   **What are some positive things about having children?*

2. What do you think are the main burdens of having children?

   [Follow up question, if not already answered]

   **What are some negative things about having children?*

3. Some people have many children, for example, five or more.
   a. In your opinion, what are the benefits of having many children?

      [Follow up question, if not already answered]

      **What factors might make people want to have five or more children?*

   b. In your opinion, what are the problems with having many children?

      [Follow up question, if not already answered]

      **What factors might make someone not want to have five or more children?*

   c. How are people who have five or more children viewed in your community?

4. And some people have few children, for example, three or fewer.
   a. In your opinion, what would be the benefits of having just a few children?

      [Follow up question, if not already answered]

      **What are some factors that might make someone want three or fewer children?*

   b. In your opinion, what are the problems with having just a few children?

      [Follow up question, if not already answered]

      **What are some factors that might make someone not want three or fewer children?*

   c. How are people who have three or fewer children viewed in your community?

5. Some people have no children, either by choice or because they cannot have children.

a. What do you think are the benefits of not having any children, if any?
[Follow up question, if not already answered]
**What are some factors that might make someone not want to have any children?*

b. What are the problems with not having any children?

c. What type of life do you think people that have no children have?

d. How are married people who have no children viewed in your community?

6. Do you think couples are having more or fewer children these days as compared to your parents' generation?

a. Why do you think they are having [more/fewer] children?
[Follow up question, if not already answered]
**What do you think are the main reasons why the number of children people have has [increased/decreased]?*

b. What do you think is the ideal family size?

7. a. If you were talking to a young woman of marriageable age, what advice would you give her about having children?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**What would your advice be concerning how many children to have?*
**What would your advice be concerning when to have children?*
**What would your advice be concerning how far apart she should plan to have her children?*

b. What about if it was a young man of the same age you were giving advice to?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**What would your advice be concerning how many children to have?*
**What would your advice be concerning when to have children?*
**What would your advice be concerning how far apart he should plan to have his children?*

8. In your opinion, how do couples decide how many children to have?
[Follow up question, if not already answered]
**What factors do they consider when deciding?*

a. Can a man decide for himself how many children to have? **Why?**
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
** Who or what may influence his decision?*
**What kinds of pressure may he face?*

b. Can a woman decide for herself how many children to have? **Why?**
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
** Who or what may influence her decision?*
**What kinds of pressure may she face?*

9. Suppose a husband and wife want different numbers of children, from what you have observed, how does this get resolved?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

**Do they decide together? Does the husband decide? Does the wife decide? Why?*

**Do other people have a say in deciding how many children they have? Who?*

Part B.2: Participant's fertility desires and alignment with partner's desires

Now I want to ask you some questions about your own childbearing desires.

For those who already have children: 10. 1. If you could go back to the time you did not have any children and choose exactly the number of children to have in your whole life:

For those who DO NOT have children: 10.2. If you could choose exactly the number of children to have in your whole life:

a. How many would that be?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

***If response is that it is up to God, then respond:** I know it is up to God, but if God lets you choose exactly how many children to have, how many would that be?

b. How many would you like to be boys? Why?

c. How many would you like to be girls? Why?

d. Why would you like to have that number of children?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

**What factors influenced your choice?*

[If participant doesn't mention any factors, ask the following follow up questions]

**How did your religion influence your choice?*

**How did your economic situation influence your choice?*

**How about other pressures from your community?*

**How did the size of the family you grew up in influence your choice?*

**How did the size of the family your [spouse/partner] grew up in influence your choice?*

**Any other factor? Please explain.*

e. Has the number of children you want changed over time?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

**How has it changed?*

**Why has it changed?*

**Who or what has influenced this change?*

**Anything/anyone else? Please explain.*

Skip if participant has 0 children 11. Earlier you said you have [X] children, and you would

want to have [X] if you could choose.

a. **If have fewer:** What are the main reasons why you have fewer children than you would want if you could choose?
   [Probing questions]
   **Any other reasons?*
   **How do you feel about having fewer children than you desire?*
   What are you doing to help you achieve your desired number of children? Or what do you plan to do?
b. **If have more:** What are the main reasons why you have more children than you would want if you could choose?
   [Probing questions]
   **Any other reasons?*
   **How do you feel about having more children than you desire?*
   What are you doing to help you prevent having more children? Or what do you plan to do?
c. **If desired number of children equals actual number:** What are you doing to help you prevent having more children? Or what do you plan to do?

12. Have you and your [spouse/partner] ever discussed how many children you would like to have?

[Follow up questions]
If respondent has discussed: Tell me about your discussion
**Who initiated the discussion?*
**What did you say? What did your [spouse/partner] say?*
**When did you first discuss this with your [spouse/partner]?*
**If you have discussed this more than once, when was the most recent time you had this conversation?*
**Were others involved in the discussion? Who? What did they say?*
If respondent has not discussed: What are the reasons why you and your [spouse/partner] have not discussed how many children you would like to have?
**If you had the opportunity to discuss how many children to have with your [spouse/partner], what would you say?*
**How do you think your [spouse/partner] would respond?*

13.a. In your opinion, do you and your [spouse/partner] agree on how many children you want, or does [she/he] want more or fewer than you want?

[Follow up question, if not already answered]
**Why do you think this is?*

b. Has the number of children [she/he] wants changed since you have been together? Why

has it changed?

Only for participants in polygynous union: 14. How has having [co-wives/multiple wives] affected your desire for children?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**How has it affected the number of children you want to have?*
**How has it affected when you felt was the right time to have [a/another] child?*
**How have concerns about inheritance affected the number of children you want to have?*
**How have concerns about status in your family affected the number of children you want to have?*

Specifically for women (except the newest wife): What kinds of changes have you noticed in your husband's desire for children with you since marrying [another wife/other wives]?
Specifically for men: What kinds of changes have you noticed in your senior [wife's/wives'] desire for children with you since you married [another wife/other wives]?

Only for participants in polygynous unions: 15. How has having [co-wives/multiple wives] affected your spouses' desire for children?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**How has it affected the number of children they want to have?*
**How has it affected when they felt was the right time to have [a/another] child?*

16. Now I have some questions about your current plans. [**For people who are currently pregnant/expecting a child:** After the child you are expecting now,] would you like to have [a/another] child, or would you prefer not to have any [more] children?

[Mandatory follow up questions]
If wants another child:
Why do you want [a/another] child?
How soon would you like to have another child?
What might make you decide against having any more children?
If does not want another child:
Why don't you want any [more] children?
What might make you decide to have more children??

Part B.3: Contraception and family planning

Now, I'd like to ask some questions about contraception and family planning.

17. Some people who want to avoid getting pregnant do not use contraception. What are some reasons why you think this occurs?

[Probing question]
**Any other reasons?*

Now let me ask you about some reasons people sometimes give:
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**How about concerns about side effects?*
**How about concerns about infertility?*
**How about concerns about acceptability (religious/cultural)?*
**How about difficulty obtaining contraception?*
**How about opposition from spouse/partner or other family members?*

18. Family planning is more available than it used to be -- do you think this affects how many children people want to have?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**Why do you think that is?*
**Does this differ for men versus women? How?*
**Do you think the availability of family planning affects how many children people actually have? How?*

19. In your household, who usually makes the decision on whether or not to use contraception?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**Can you please describe how these decisions are made?*
** Are decisions made by you alone? Your [wife/husband/partner] alone? You and your [wife/husband/partner] jointly? Or by someone else?*
If participant says someone else: *Who is this person? Why does this person decide?*

Only ask those who do not want any (more) children or who want them later: 20. Earlier, you said that you do not want [a/another] child [**for those who want at a later time:** anytime soon]. Are you using any method to prevent pregnancy?

[Probe]
If yes: What method(s) are you using to prevent pregnancy? Why?
If no: Can you tell me why you are not using a method to prevent pregnancy?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**If you were interested in using contraception, how would you decide this with your [spouse/partner]?*

If not using a method to delay or avoid getting pregnant: *Would you like to use a method to delay or avoid pregnancy in the future?*

Thank you very much for the very thoughtful responses you have shared with me today. I really appreciate your patience and feedback. Do you have anything you would like to add that we did not cover during our conversation?

Thank you very much!

IF SELECTED FOR A COUPLE INTERVIEW

Ask: *Do you agree to participate in an interview with your spouse or partner?*

If yes, PROCEED. If 'no', thank them for their time and end the interview.